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ATLANTA ARREST AND PRESIDENTIAL POLITICS

I fear that there is a dearth of vision in our government, a lack of a sense of history and genuine morality.

JUNE 23, 1960
King discusses civil rights with presidential candidate Senator John F. Kennedy

OCTOBER 19
Is arrested at Atlanta sit-in

OCTOBER 25
Charges are dropped for sit-in arrest but King is held for violating probation for earlier traffic offense and transferred to Reidsville State Prison

OCTOBER 26
Presidential candidate John F. Kennedy calls Coretta Scott King to express sympathy and offer assistance; Robert Kennedy calls Georgia governor S. Ernest Vandiver and Judge Oscar Mitchell seeking King's release on bail

OCTOBER 27
King's attorney Donald L. Hollowell arranges release from prison

NOVEMBER 1
King applauds Senator Kennedy for support

NOVEMBER 8
Kennedy wins close election, receiving strong support from black voters

My first contact with John Kennedy was when he was a senator seeking the nomination for President. For several months, we had tried to work out a meeting and every time I could go he was away. Finally we worked out an engagement at his apartment in New York. That was June of 1960, about a month before the convention.

We talked for about an hour over the breakfast table. I was very frank about what I thought: that there was a need for a strong executive leadership